PARTNERS *of the* AMERICAS
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FY 2023 TRADITIONAL PUBLIC-PRIVATE PARTNERSHIP PROGRAM (EDUCATION AND CULTURE PROGRAM 2023): BUDGET NARRATIVE

Partners of the Americas

Partners of the Americas (POA) has prepared a budget as requested by the U.S. Department of State Bureau of Educational and Cultural Affairs (ECA). The budget requests a total of $367,110 from ECA. POA will provide $97,478 for a total program budget of $464,588.

POA has established sound financial management and internal control systems ensuring expenditures are allowable and classified in accordance with internationally accepted accounting principles. POA employs a fully automated accounting system and have annual A-133 audits. The Finance and Administration (F&A) department is staffed with a talented group of professionals with years of experience related to financial administration and reporting. The finance department is made up of a Director of Compliance, a Controller, a Grants Analyst, an Accounts Payable Finance Officer, a Field Finance Officer, a Budget Analyst, and a Chief Financial Officer (CFO) with over 30 years of experience in the fields of finance and accounting, auditing, managing the financial reporting aspects reporting aspects of US Government (USG) grants and contracts, and has significant experience overseeing cooperative agreements. The F&A team works closely with project staff at POA's headquarters (HQ) to monitor spending, ensure costs are allowable, and support implementation of the project in accordance with USG rules and regulations (particularly 2 CFR 200), local laws, as well as POA's internal policies. Our accountants also review spending with project directors on a monthly basis and assist with oversight of sub-recipients, end-of-project reporting, and other aspects of project monitoring.

POA uses a robust and cost-effective strategy to determine cost allocation in accordance with USG cost principles, local laws, and internal policies. Our proposed budget for this project was developed by conducting thorough price analyses to identify realistic and fair market values for all projected expenses. Our budget estimates were also calculated based on past experience in implementing effective and cost-efficient USG-funded programs. The budget narrative that follows will elaborate on each line item presented in the budget.

- Individual line items are discussed below following the budget table format requested in the Proposal Submission Instructions.
- Travel costs have been estimated from a survey of airline quotes, USG per diem and lodging rates, and are not specified until final participant selection takes place.

Partners of the Americas
FY 2023 Traditional Public-Private Partnership Program (Education and Culture Program)
CFDA 19.415 / Funding Opportunity #SFOP0009274

Budget Summary	Educational and Cultural Affairs	Cost Sharing	Total
Program Costs	**$177,287**	**$83,178**	**$260,465**
Program costs per participant	$5,910	$2,772.59	$8,682
Administrative Costs	**$189,823**	**$14,301**	**$204,123**
Administrative costs per participant	$6,327	$476.69	$6,804
Total Costs	**$367,110**	**$97,478**	**$464,588**
Total costs per participant Number of Participants: 30	$12,237	$3,249	$15,486

Salaries
Subtotal Salaries: **$102,493**
ECA Request: **$88,193**
Cost Share: **$14,301**

I. Salaries*
POA has budgeted for one (1) Program Director, one (1) Senior Program Officer, one (1) Program Assistant, and general program support at POA's headquarters. Proposed salaries are also consistent with those paid to other personnel engaged in similar work within and outside of POA. Level of effort (LOE) budgeted is based on the scope of the program proposed. The average monthly salaries include a projected 3.5% increase in 2024 to account for inflation and merit increases for all staff, consistent with HQ policies. POA is budgeting salary at a limited LOE as indicated below, as some staff time will be split between the proposed Education and Culture program FY2023 and prior award Education and Culture FY2022 as they work to close the prior award and start implementation of the new award.

1. The **Program Director**, whose monthly salary is $6,400/month will be responsible for financial and programmatic management; supervising staff and managing all aspects of day-to-day activities; maintaining regular communication with ECA and PAS; and ensuring program compliance with regulations. From March 2023 – September 2024 the Program Director will contribute 10% LOE to the program. The total for the life of the project is **$12,362.**

2. The **Senior Program Officer**, whose salary is $5,177/month will be responsible for coordinating the day-to-day activities including reviewing proposed travel grant applications and/or subaward applications; collecting all required documents; preparing and delivering orientation packets; maintaining program budgets; ensuring receipt of the required evaluations and reports; and assisting with semi-annual and final program

reports. From March – June 2023, the Senior Program Officer will work at a limited LOE of 20%. July 2023 – April 2024 this position will increase to 50%. From May – September 2024 the Senior Program Officer will reduce LOE and dedicate 20% of time to the project. The total for the life of the project is **$35,747.**

3. The **Program Assistant**, whose salary is $4,500/month will dedicate 25% of her time from March – May 2023. From June 2023 – September 2024 she will increase LOE to 50% of time contributed to the project. She will work with interested Chapters and participants on recruitment; provide training on the Travel Grant application process; organize review committees and selection processes; work with the communications officer on monthly messages for e-Newsletters and periodically update the website; assist with program reports; and monitor and evaluate the progress of the project. The total for the life of the project is **$40,084.**

4. As cost share, POA will contribute program support, which are volunteers who will assist in outreach, grantee support, and other programmatic needs as necessary to ensure a successful program. POA has budgeted Program Support for 19 months. POA estimates the hourly rate at $21.80/hour which is based on the U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics' average hourly rate for administrative support personnel. POA estimates 8 hours/day for 1 day/week for 82 weeks. To keep administrative costs to a minimum, **POA will provide this support as volunteer cost share in the amount of $14,301**.

Fringe Benefits
Subtotal Fringe Benefits: **$20,699**
ECA Request: **$20,699**

II. Fringe Benefits*

In accordance with POA's personnel policy a 23.47% fringe rate is applied to POA Headquarters staff salaries. Fringe benefits include insurance, mandatory taxes, pension, and other employee benefits. The total cost is **$20,699**.

Travel
Subtotal Travel: **$88,775**
ECA Request: **$88,775**

III.Travel

1. ***Staff Travel***

a. *Domestic Round-Trip Airfare*: Budgeted costs for flights are based on a sample of various cities throughout the U.S. and past experiences conducting program visits for prior programs. The domestic airfare is intended to be used for one (1) staff member to travel for a site visit or other sponsored event. POA anticipates one (1) trip at **$600** per round trip ticket.

b. *Domestic Lodging & Per Diem:* Budgeted costs for lodging and per diem are based on a sample of various cities throughout the U.S. and past experiences conducting program visits for prior programs. POA has budgeted a reduced USG per diem rate of $50/day plus $130/day for lodging for five (5) days on one (1) trip. The total cost is **$900.**

c. *International Round Trip Airfare*: Budgeted costs for flights are based on a sample of various cities throughout the region and past experiences conducting monitoring visits for prior programs. POA anticipates one (1) trip at **$1,400** for a round trip ticket. The purpose of this trip will be to monitor program progress and attend a sponsored event.

d. *International Lodging & Per Diem:* Budgeted costs for lodging and per diem are based on a sample of various cities throughout the region and past experiences conducting program visits for prior programs. POA has budgeted a reduced USG per diem rate of $65/day and $160/day for lodging for seven (7) days on one (1) trip. The total cost is **$1,575**.

2. *Participant Travel*

a. *Round Trip Airfare:* Budgeted costs for flights are based on a sample of various cities throughout the region and past experiences implementing the Education and Culture award. POA anticipates 30 trips at an average cost of $2,000 per round trip ticket for a total of **$60,000.**

b. *International/Domestic Per Diem:* Budgeted costs for per diem are based on a sample of various cities throughout the region and past experiences implementing the Education and Culture award. POA estimates a reduced per diem rate of $50/day for 10 days each trip for a total of 30 trips. The daily per diem rate is intended to cover travel related expenses such as meals and incidental costs, transportation to and from the airport, and other miscellaneous travel expenses. POA Chapters will provide lodging to participants; thus, POA has not budgeted for lodging. The total cost is **$15,000**.

c. *Visa Fees:* POA estimates visa expenses at a rate of $180 each for an estimated ten (10) U.S. participants, for a total of **$1,800.** There are currently a handful of LAC countries that require visa for U.S. citizens. As POA is unable to predict to which countries U.S. citizens will plan to travel as part of the program, POA anticipate providing reimbursements for 10 travelers. The Department of State will cover expenses related to the J-1 visas for 20 LAC participants.

d. *Visa-related Travel Fees*: To increase accessibility and inclusion within the program, especially for prospective travelers from more rural areas in their countries, POA estimates providing a maximum limit of $250 per participant to assist in covering travel-related costs for visa appointments. POA anticipates 30 participants at a maximum reimbursement of $250 each for a total of **$7,500**.

Contractual
Subtotal Contractual: **$73,500**
ECA Request: **$42,000**
Cost Share: **$31,500**

IV.Contractual

a. *Large Subawards*: POA has budgeted for two (2) large project assistance subawards at an average of $16,500 each. In addition, POA estimates in-kind cost share from subrecipients at $12,375/subaward for two (2) subawards. In-kind cost share will be a combination of donated volunteer time, supplies, and other materials to support the subaward program. The large project assistance subawards will support community-led initiatives aligned with the Program's objectives and ECA's strategic goals. General themes for this cycle would be access to education, environmental protection and resilience, inclusion of underserved communities, inclusive economic growth and entrepreneurship and media literacy/countering disinformation. The large subawards will be for community-based organizations throughout the U.S. and Latin America. The total **in-kind cost share** provided is estimated at **$24,750**. Total ECA costs are estimated at **$33,000.**

b. *Small Subawards*: POA has budgeted for three (3) small project assistance subawards at an average of $3,000 each. In addition, POA estimates in-kind cost share from subrecipients at $2,250/subaward for three (3) subawards. In-kind cost share will be a combination of donated volunteer time, supplies, and other materials to support the subaward programming. General themes for this cycle would be access to education, environmental protection and resilience, inclusion of underserved communities, inclusive economic growth and entrepreneurship and media literacy/countering disinformation. The subawards can be used to develop a series of learning exchanges, build educational communities, to purchase materials for exchange program activities, showcase art from other countries, or to organize community-building activities, among other plans. The small subawards will be for community-based organizations throughout the U.S. and Latin America including POA's network members. The total **in-kind cost share** provided is estimated at **$6,750**. Total ECA costs are estimated at **$9,000.**

Other Direct Costs
Subtotal Other Direct Costs: **$98,190**
ECA Request: **$46,512**
Cost Share: **$51,678**

VIII. Other Direct Costs

1. ***Honoraria***

a. *Logistics Consultant:* POA estimates working with a logistics consultant who will support event planning, program coordination, and travel grant logistics at a rate of $325/day for 85 days, for a total of **$27,625**. This is based on previous rates for event planning consultants and program and logistic coordinators with a similar scope of work. The logistics coordinator will ensure robust participation from POA's network of alumni and members in follow-on events and professional development activities, leads the successful integration of virtual platforms, liaises with the grant representative, and provides support to the program.

2. ***Fees***

a. *Monitoring and Evaluation:* POA estimates monitoring and evaluation services, which will include updating an M&E database, creating survey tools, and providing data analysis. Based on prior experience for similar scope of works, the M&E consultant is at a rate of $255/day for 15 days for a total cost of **$3,825.**

3. ***Events***

a. *Event Costs – One-Day, In-Person Peer Learning Event:* The one-day, in-person peer learning event will coincide either immediately before or after POA's What Works Conference with the main objective of creating a space for Education and Culture staff, ECA, PAS, and participants to network, learn, and discuss key topics related to the program's themes and ECA key priority areas. The event is budgeted to receive $5,000 to arrange the conference logistics, sessions, presenters, keynote speakers, and networking opportunities. POA has budgeted **$5,000** for this peer learning event. In addition, POA has budgeted **$5,000 in additional funds as cost share** for the event. The in-kind funds will help cover the venue and AV equipment rentals, and accessibility accommodations.

4. ***Communications***

a. *Promotion & Communications:* POA is budgeting to increase social media engagement with ad boosts to augment the visibility of the program at key times, such as for participant recruitment, subaward call for proposals, and registration for peer learning events. POA is budgeting for a total of **$882.**

b. *Platform Subscriptions:* POA is budgeted for program specific subscriptions such as Formstack, Zoom, Monday.com, Microsoft 365, and other online tools to assist

in program management. POA is budgeting for approximately $100/month for 19 months for a total of **$1,900.**

c. *Online Platform for E-Trainings and Subaward Management:* POA is budgeting for an online training webinar and subaward management platform called Zengine by WizeHive. The platform will host and centralize all relevant programmatic resources including application and funding guidelines, financial templates, proposal writing tips, and grant management training materials. The platform will allow an applicant to track and save their application, but also if awarded, their reports. Additionally, it allows users to select their preferred language to view the application and grant materials. Based off provider quotes, POA is budgeting approximately $120/month for 19 months for a total of **$2,280.**

5. *Materials*

a. *Translation and Interpretation Services:* POA anticipates an average cost of **$5,000** for translation of program documents and interpretation services for peer learning events. As appropriate, peer learning events, will be in three languages: English, Spanish, and Portuguese.

6. *Volunteer Time*

a. *Volunteer Time:* POA will contribute **$46,678** in volunteer time as cost sharing throughout the life of the project.

U.S. and LAC Volunteer Time				
Item	**# Vol-days**	**Daily Rate**	**Travel/project grants**	**Total Cost Share**
Non-U.S. (LAC) Volunteers				
Participant selection/planning and preparation	2	56.00	20	$ 2,240
Orientation	2	56.00	20	$ 2,240
Follow-on engagement	5	56.00	20	$ 5,600
Sub total				**$ 10,080**
U.S. Volunteers				
Participant selection/planning and preparation	2	406.64	10	$ 8,133
Orientation	2	406.64	10	$ 8,133
Follow-on engagement	5	406.64	10	$ 20,332
Sub total				**$ 36,598**
Total volunteer time match				**$ 46,678**

POA's accounting system for volunteer time operates under the principle that the person must directly report the actual time volunteered using standard forms (timesheet) and guidelines. POA does not count estimates of volunteer time and our approach is conservative—if there is a reasonable doubt about the validity of submitted hours, POA does not count them. POA has

divided time valuation into the three categories stated below. This approach to valuing volunteer time in each of the categories listed below has been reviewed and approved by our auditors:

1. Volunteers who reside in the U.S. POA values its volunteers as cost share as they are professional and technical personnel, consultants, and other skilled labor which are an integral and necessary part of the program. To properly value contributed services from United States volunteers, POA bases the valuation on fair market value. To derive the fair market value, POA bases it on the most recent Occupational Employment Statistics provided by the Bureau of Labor Statistics for all occupations (https://www.bls.gov/oes/current/oes_nat.htm#00-0000). Based on the specialized services provided by individuals with those skills (as they indicate on their signed timesheets), the mean hourly rate will be used to calculate the total value of their contributed services. This valuation is compliant with the 2 CFR 200 which states: *Volunteer services furnished by third-party professional and technical personnel, consultants, and other skilled and unskilled labor may be counted as cost sharing or matching if the service is an integral and necessary part of an approved project or program. Rates for third-party volunteer services must be consistent with those paid for similar work by the non-Federal entity. In those instances, in which the required skills are not found in the non-Federal entity, rates must be consistent with those paid for similar work in the labor market in which the non-Federal entity competes for the kind of services involved. In either case, paid fringe benefits that are reasonable, necessary, allocable, and otherwise allowable may be included in the valuation.*

   For U.S. volunteers POA is budgeting two (2) days for participant selection, planning and preparation, two (2) days for orientation, and five (5) days for follow-on engagement for each of the 10 volunteers. Based on experience implementing this type of program, POA has calculated eight (8) hours per day. The actual number of hours that each volunteer spends executing the program, however, will be carefully documented following uniform POA guidelines and reported to ECA with the final report. Given the expertise of these individual POA is estimating an average of $50.83/hour, which according to the U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics is the average hourly rate for educational training professionals. **The total cost share contribute is $36,598.**

2. Volunteers who reside in Latin America and the Caribbean. For non-U.S. volunteers POA is budgeting two (2) days for participant selection, planning and preparation, two (2) days for orientation, and five (5) days for follow-on engagement for each of the 20 non-U.S. volunteers. Based on experience implementing this type of program, POA has calculated eight (8) hours per day. The actual number of hours that each volunteer spends executing the program, however, will be carefully documented following uniform POA guidelines and reported to ECA with the final report. To create a similar fair market value estimate for POA volunteers in non-U.S. countries, the GNI per capita for each country (as reported by the World Bank and adjusted for inflation and purchasing power parity) was used to calculate the volunteer time. The resulting hour value for non-U.S. time is approximately $7.00 per hour (or $56.00 per day). **The total cost share contribute is $10,080.**

Indirect Costs
Subtotal Indirect Costs: **$80,931**
ECA Request: **$80,931**

VIII. Indirect Costs

In accordance with POA's NICRA letter, indirect costs are calculated at 28.28% of total direct costs. Please see copy of the NICRA letter attached. Total NICRA for this program is **$80,931.**